VANTAGECIRCLE

DIWALI 2026 · FREE HR TOOLKIT

Diwali Celebration at Work

Badges to share, greeting emails to send, a five-day recognition plan, celebration ideas and gifting tips. Everything HR and managers need to celebrate with teams anywhere.



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01

DIWALI CARDS

Light up a colleague's Diwali

Pick the badge that fits someone you work with. Add a few words and we'll send it to them as a Diwali card. It takes a minute, and they'll remember it longer than that.

TIPS FOR A CARD THEY'LL KEEP

- **Be specific.** "Thanks for staying late on the launch" lands better than "thanks for everything".
- **Think beyond your team.** The person in IT or finance who helped you out deserves one too.
- **Send it before the break.** Diwali falls on Sunday, 8 November, so cards sent by Friday arrive while people are still at work.



Muskaan Ka Diya

A lamp of smiles

For the colleague who makes everyone smile, even on hard days.



Khushiyon Ka Pitara

A box of happiness

For the colleague who brings something good wherever they go.



Mithaas Ki Potli

A bundle of sweetness

For the colleague who makes work feel a little sweeter.



Umeed Ki Phuljhadi

A sparkler of hope

For the colleague who keeps the team hopeful when things get tough.



Energy Booster

For the colleague who lifts the room when energy drops.



Joy Maker

For the colleague who makes work more fun.



Kindness Keeper

For the colleague who is kind even when nobody's watching.



Team Spirit Booster

For the colleague who brings the team together.

02

GREETING EMAILS

Send warm Diwali wishes

Four ready-to-send emails for different moments. Fill in the highlighted bits, make it sound like you, and send.

BEFORE YOU HIT SEND

- **Wish everyone.** Not everyone celebrates Diwali, and that's fine. A warm note works for all.
- **Name a real moment.** One specific win from the year makes the whole email feel personal.
- **Mind the calendar.** Many colleagues in India take time off around Diwali. Send early in the week.

FOR THE WHOLE COMPANY

Subject: Wishing you a bright Diwali

Hi everyone,

Diwali, the festival of lights, is here. For many of our colleagues, it means diyas in the window, sweets on every table and long evenings with family.

It's also a good moment to look back at the year and notice the people who made it brighter. The colleague who picked up extra work without being asked. The one who always had an answer. The one who made Mondays a little easier.

This week, take a minute to thank one of them. A short note is enough.

Wishing you and your loved ones a happy Diwali, full of light, good food and rest.

Warmly,
[Your name]

FROM A MANAGER TO THEIR TEAM

Subject: Thank you for lighting up this year

Hi team,

Before we break for Diwali, I wanted to say thank you.

This year asked a lot of us. [Name a real moment: the launch, the migration, the busy season]. You showed up for it, and for each other.

On Diwali, every diya adds a little more light to the room. That's what each of you did for this team. It made a difference, and I noticed.

Enjoy the break. Eat too many sweets. Come back rested.

Happy Diwali,
[Your name]

FOR TEAMS ACROSS COUNTRIES

Subject: A little light from us to you: Happy Diwali

Hi everyone,

Some of you are celebrating Diwali this week, and some of you may be hearing about it for the first time.

Diwali is the festival of lights, celebrated by millions of Hindus, Sikhs, Jains and Buddhists around the world. Homes are lit with small clay lamps called diyas, doorways are decorated with colorful rangoli, and families share sweets and gifts. At its heart, it's a celebration of light over darkness.

If you're celebrating, we hope you have a wonderful time with the people you love. If you're not, it's a lovely excuse to wish a colleague well and share something sweet.

Happy Diwali from all of us,
[Your name]

FOR SLACK, TEAMS OR A QUICK MESSAGE

Subject: Happy Diwali!

Happy Diwali, [Name]! 🪔 Thanks for being a bright spot on this team all year. Hope your week is full of sweets, lights and good company.

Wishing you and your family a very happy Diwali. Thank you for everything you did for us this year. Enjoy the break!

Happy Diwali to the best team I know. Thank you for every late call, quick fix and good laugh this year. Go light some diyas. ✨

RECOGNITION CAMPAIGN

03 Run five days of light

Diwali celebrations stretch over five days. Borrow the idea for work: one small recognition moment a day, each tied to a Diwali tradition. Run it the week before the festival.

HOW TO RUN IT

- **Announce it 2 to 3 days before.** Share the five themes in one message so people can plan.
- **Make it open to all.** You don't need to celebrate Diwali to thank someone.
- **Use the badges.** Ask people to tag each shoutout with one of the 8 badges above.

DAY 1

Clean slate

Before Diwali, homes get a deep clean to welcome something new.

At work: thank the person who cleared a blocker, fixed a mess or tidied up a process nobody else wanted to touch.



DAY 2

Rangoli

A rangoli is made one color at a time, often by many hands.

At work: recognize a cross-team effort and name everyone who added a color to it.



DAY 3

Mithai

Sweets are shared with everyone, not only family.

At work: ask each person to send one sweet note to a colleague they don't usually work with.



DAY 4

Diya

One diya can light another without losing its own flame.

At work: recognize a mentor or teammate who helped someone else learn and grow.



DAY 5

Gifts and greetings

The festival ends with gifts, visits and warm wishes.

At work: managers share a roundup of the week's shoutouts, hand out badges and send the team off with Diwali wishes.

Shoutouts you can copy

Four templates for every direction. Swap in the details and post them on your recognition platform, in chat or by email.

PEER TO PEER

Happy Diwali, [Name]! Thank you for [specific thing they did]. You made [project or week] so much easier, and I don't think I said it enough. Sending a little light back your way.

MANAGER TO TEAM

Team, as we head into Diwali, I want to recognize how you [specific achievement]. Every one of you added something to it, like diyas lighting up a room. Thank you, and Happy Diwali.

MANAGER TO EMPLOYEE

[Name], your work on [project] this year stood out. You [specific action], and it [result for the team or customer]. Thank you for bringing so much light to this team. Happy Diwali!

EMPLOYEE TO MANAGER

[Name], thank you for [specific support or advice] this year. Your guidance made a real difference to me, and I wanted you to know. Wishing you a happy and restful Diwali.

CELEBRATION IDEAS

04 Celebrate together, wherever you are

Ideas for the office and for teams spread across cities and time zones. Pick two or three, not all of them.

KEEP IT SAFE AND EASY

- **Use LED diyas indoors.** Skip open flames and firecrackers at the office.
- **Keep it optional.** Dress-up days and contests work best when nobody feels they have to join.
- **Plan around leave.** Hold events a few days before Diwali, when most people are still around.



In the office

Rangoli contest

Teams design a rangoli at the entrance using colored powder, flowers or rice. Give them 45 minutes and judge on teamwork, not art skills.

Diya painting

Set out plain clay diyas, paints and glitter. People paint one to take home and one for the office.

Sweets potluck

Everyone brings a sweet from their home region or culture. Label each one with its name and story.

Festive dress day

Traditional or festive wear, open to everyone. Set up a decorated corner for team photos.

Light up the floor

String lights, marigold garlands and paper lanterns. Let each team decorate its own corner.



Hybrid and remote

Rangoli at home

People make a small rangoli with whatever they have, from spices to flower petals, and share a photo in one channel.

Festive background day

Everyone joins calls with a Diwali background or a real diya on their desk.

Sweets by delivery

Send a food delivery voucher so everyone can order their favorite mithai on the same day.

How I celebrate

A 30-minute call where a few colleagues share how their family marks Diwali. Great for global teams.

Team Diwali playlist

Everyone adds one festive song. Play it during the last meeting of the week.

Host a rangoli or decor contest

Works in the office, at home, or both.

1. **Pick 3 or 4 awards**
   Choose from the list, or make up your own.
2. **Collect entries**
   Photos from the office floor, or uploads from people working remotely. Give everyone two days.
3. **Open a 24-hour vote**
   One vote per person per category. Keep it in a channel everyone can see.
4. **Announce winners**
   On the last workday before Diwali, with a badge and a small gift.



Best rangoli

Colors, patterns, teamwork



Most creative diya

Painted, decorated, or made from scratch



Best festive outfit

Traditional or your own twist



Best decorated desk

Lights, flowers, lanterns



Best virtual background

For the remote crowd



Best team spirit

The team that went all in

05

DIWALI GIFTING

Send something sweet

Gifts are a big part of Diwali. Match the gift to where people work, and add a personal note so it feels like more than a box.

GIFTING TIPS

- **Order early.** Couriers get busy in Diwali week. Ship physical gifts at least 10 days ahead.
- **Check dietary needs.** Offer sugar-free, vegan or nut-free options.
- **Go digital for remote teams.** Vouchers and e-gift cards arrive on time, in any country.

In the office



Mithai box
Classic sweets with a note from the team



Dry fruit hamper
Travels well, suits most diets



Diya and lantern kit
Hand-painted or LED, for home

Anywhere in the world



E-gift cards
They pick what they want



Food delivery voucher
A festive dinner at home



Experience voucher
A movie, a spa or a meal out



A plant
Lasts longer than sweets



Let them choose
Reward points that work in any country



+



OUR FAVORITE

Mix and match

Pair any gift with a Diwali badge and a personal note. The gift gets opened once. The note gets kept.

Celebrating with a global team

Diwali is celebrated around the world, but not by everyone. A few things that help it feel welcoming to all.

1

Explain, don't assume

Share a line or two about what Diwali is. People enjoy learning about it.

2

Invite, don't require

Everything here should be opt-in. Thanking a colleague is open to everyone.

3

Plan around time off

Avoid big deadlines in Diwali week, and pick event times that work across time zones.

4

Know it's not one story

Sikhs mark Bandi Chhor Divas and Jains mark Mahavira's nirvana at the same time. Traditions vary by region and family.

Make appreciation part of the celebration

Send a free Diwali card to a colleague at vantagecircle.com/diwali-at-work